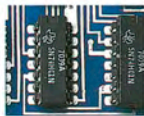
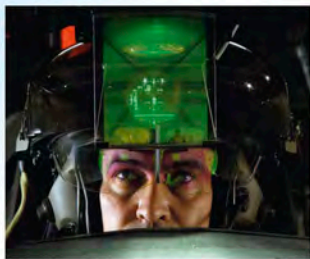


COMPUTER MAGIC



Computers are the world's smartest machines. Inside a computer are thousands of very tiny electronic switches, a bit like light switches. By switching them on and off in different combinations, computers can perform all kinds of tasks. They are used everywhere, from factories and hospitals to stores and offices. Some guide aircraft, ships, submarines, and spacecraft. Others are used just for having fun, such as playing games and watching movies.



Keeping your head up

A jet fighter pilot must not take their eyes off the view ahead, even for a second. All the information they need to control the plane and fire at targets is fed to a computer, and projected onto the pilot's face mask. This is called a "head-up" display.



Seeing inside

Doctors can use a CT (computed tomography) scanner to see inside a patient's body. A CT scanner uses X-rays to create images of "slices" through the body. These are put together on a computer to create a 3-D image, which doctors use to see what needs treating.